A NEW BOOK ABOUT SWIFTS THAT BREED IN ITALY

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We are writing a new book about the three swift species that breed in Italy. The book will be available for sale soon, with shipping options. It will include all the research we have been conducting in northern Italy on the **mapping of swift colonies** in five provinces (more than 1,300 buildings with breeding swifts have been identified), **surveys of nesting structures** in four provinces of Lombardy and Piedmont (more than 240 structures recorded, Colombo *et al.*, 2024), and several **new findings concerning the Common swift**.

We assessed the **breeding phenology** of three colonies, **reproductive success** over an eight-year period (Zanchin *et al.*, 2025), the **primary moult** of breeding individuals (Boano *et al.*, 2022), the presence of **microplastics in chick diets** (Costanzo *et al.*, 2024) and the **first deployment of IoT tracking devices** on Common swift (Morganti *et al.*, 2024).

The book also explores the **urban ecology** of swifts in northern Italy and provides guidance on conserving colonies in cities, illustrating **best practices** for architectural and building interventions. Finally, we present several other **associations and groups in Italy and worldwide** that are involved in swift conservation.

The book also features original illustrations and numerous photographs taken during our research activities. It is written in Italian, with a short English version of each chapter.



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Illustrations: Sabrina Luoni; graphic of the book: Luca Beretta

Every chapter has a summary in English

Lavishly illustrated with pictures and graphs with English captions

With an extensive bibliography

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